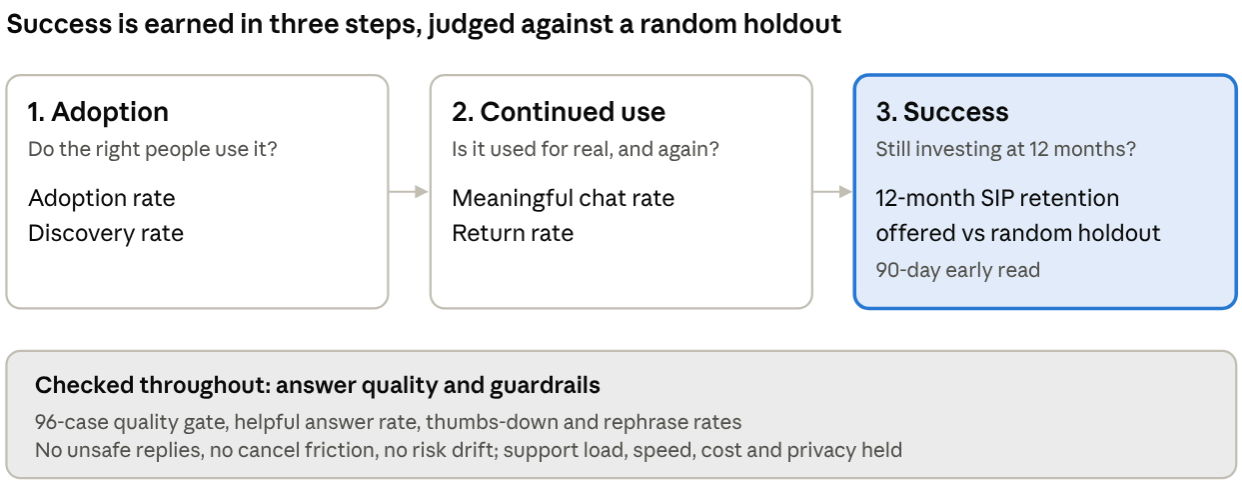
My SIP Buddy: Success Metrics, Risks and Mitigation

Nov 8, 2026

SIP Buddy succeeds if first-year SIP investors adopt it, keep using it for real questions, and those offered it are still investing after 12 months at a higher rate than a random group that wasn't.



success framework · three steps and the checks under them

Each step depends on the one before it: retention can't move if people don't find SIP Buddy, or open it and leave after the welcome message.

Part 7.1 Adoption: do the right people use it?

Adoption is measured among **first-year SIP investors who log in to Coin**, the people SIP Buddy is built for. Counting every login would include long-time investors and stock-only traders, and would drag the number down without saying anything about the feature.

Primary metric: adoption rate

```
\text{Adoption rate} = \frac{\text{first-year SIP investors who opened SIP Buddy and sent at least 1 message in the month}}{\text{first-year SIP investors who logged in to Coin in the month}}
```

Supporting metric: discovery rate

```
\text{Discovery rate} = \frac{\text{first-year SIP investors who saw the SIP Buddy entry point in the month}}{\text{first-year SIP investors who logged in to Coin in the month}}
```

Why both: if adoption is low, discovery tells you why. Low discovery means people didn't find the feature, which is a placement problem. High discovery with low adoption means they saw it and chose not to use it, which is a value or messaging problem. The all-users version (anyone who logged in) can be reported alongside, but decisions use the first-year number.

Hypothesis target: 10 to 20% monthly adoption among first-year SIP investors within 3 months of launch, with discovery above 60%.

Part 7.2 Continued use: is it used for real, and again?

Opening a chat and reading the welcome message isn't use. Continued use has two sides: a chat that goes past the introduction, and a user who comes back later.

Metric 1: meaningful chat rate

A chat counts as meaningful when the user sent at least 2 of their own messages *and* got at least one answer backed by data: a goal check, an own-SIP check, a fund-type comparison, payment help, a tax estimate or an explained topic. Starter-button taps and the welcome message don't count as user messages.

```
\text{Meaningful chat rate} = \frac{\text{chats with} \geq 2 \text{ user messages and} \geq 1 \text{ data-backed answer}}{\text{chats started}}
```

Metric 2: return rate

```
\text{Return rate} = \frac{\text{users who had a meaningful chat in month } t \text{ and used SIP Buddy again within the next 60 days}}{\text{users who had a meaningful chat in month } t}
```

A user who comes back when the next instalment fails or the portfolio dips is the behaviour that matters most for retention.

Why not tokens or time on their own

- **Tokens** measure how much the AI wrote, not how engaged the user was. A long answer, a tool loop or a rewrite all raise tokens without the user doing anything more. Tokens stay in the cost guardrail (7.4).
- **Time in chat** is ambiguous. A user who is confused for four minutes, or has left the tab open, looks engaged. Median time per meaningful chat is reported as a secondary signal, not a target.

Hypothesis targets: meaningful chat rate of at least 50%, and a 60-day return rate of at least 30%.

Part 7.3 Success: are more people still investing after 12 months?

The feature succeeds when first-year SIP investors who were **offered** SIP Buddy have a higher 12-month SIP retention than a **randomly chosen group who weren't**, by a margin that isn't chance.

The metric: 12-month SIP retention

$$\text{12-month SIP retention} = \frac{\text{investors in the month-}m\text{ group with an active SIP and a successful instalment in month } m+12}{\text{investors who started their first-ever SIP on Coin in month } m}$$

- **First-time investor:** no mutual fund or stock holding on Coin or Kite before the first SIP.
- **Still investing:** at least one SIP active in month 12, and its month-12 instalment succeeded. A SIP stopped and restarted within the year still counts.
- **Companion measure, SIP book retention:** rupees collected in month 12 ÷ rupees in the group's first instalments. It stops a rise that comes only from small SIPs from looking like success.

Why a random holdout, not users vs non-users

Comparing people who chose to use SIP Buddy with people who didn't would flatter the feature. Investors who open a SIP help chat are already more engaged and committed, so they would likely stay longer anyway. Their retention would look higher and SIP Buddy would get credit it didn't earn. So who gets the feature is decided by random draw:

1. New first-year SIP investors are randomly split at their first instalment: 80% are offered SIP Buddy, 20% are held out and don't see it.
2. Retention is compared for **everyone offered** vs **everyone held out**, whether or not they used SIP Buddy. Usage only explains the result.
3. Both groups start in the same months, so a market fall or a Budget change hits both equally.

Success rule

$$\text{Lift} = \text{retention}_{\text{offered}} - \text{retention}_{\text{holdout}} \geq 2 \text{ percentage points, with } p < 0.05$$

The target range is +2 to +5 percentage points, with SIP book retention not lower. +2 points is the smallest lift worth scaling for; +5 is the stretch.

How many people (the n)

To detect a 2-point lift from a baseline near 80%, at 95% confidence and 80% power, each group needs about 6,300 investors. With 100 per group, a 2-point difference would be indistinguishable from chance.

Coin's real baseline retention will change this number; a lower baseline needs more people.

Early read at 90 days

Twelve months is long to wait to learn something is broken. The same comparison is read at 90 days (90-day SIP retention, same definition) as an early signal to keep going, fix or stop. The 12-month result is the final verdict.

Part 7.4 Supporting checks: answer quality and guardrails

These aren't success criteria. They make sure the three parts above can be trusted: that SIP Buddy is helping, and that retention isn't rising for the wrong reasons.

Answer quality: is SIP Buddy actually helping?

Check	Formula	Line
Quality gate before every release	test cases passed ÷ 96, and safety cases passed ÷ 38	at least 85% overall and 100% safety (agent-v2 passed 95 of 96, 38 of 38, on 8 Nov 2026)
Helpful answer rate	replies a reviewer scores as answering the question with correct facts ÷ replies reviewed (100 a week)	at least 85%
Thumbs-down rate	thumbs-down ÷ replies rated	below 10%
Rephrase rate	chats where the user asks the same thing again within 2 turns ÷ chats	below 15%

The rephrase rate is the clearest sign a first answer missed. It was the main problem with the earlier, non-agent version.

Guardrails: retention mustn't rise for the wrong reasons

Guardrail	Formula	Line that pauses rollout
Unsafe replies	replies a reviewer marks as naming a fund, giving advice, predicting or pressuring ÷ replies reviewed	any confirmed case
Cancel friction	median seconds from opening the cancel screen to a confirmed cancel, offered ÷ holdout	ratio above 1.1
Risk drift	share of new SIP money going to small cap or sector funds, offered − holdout	above +3 points
Support load	support tickets per 1,000 first-year users, offered ÷ holdout	ratio above 1.05
Fallback rate	replies served from pre-written answers ÷ messages	above 5% for a week
Speed	95th-percentile seconds from send to reply	above 12 seconds
Cost	AI spend (tokens) per monthly active SIP Buddy user	above an agreed rupee cap
Personal data	messages where a PAN, account number, phone or email reached the AI service ÷ messages	any case

Part 8. Risks and mitigation

The risks are grouped by the part of success they threaten. The ones most likely to sink the feature are not about the AI misbehaving, which the quality gate already controls. They are that people never find SIP Buddy at the moment they would stop, and that the 12-month result is misread.

Risks to adoption

Risk	Why it could happen	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation	Watch
Not found at the moment someone stops	People cancel from their bank app or let instalments fail; a chat tab they never open helps no one	High	High	Open SIP Buddy from where the moments happen: the failed-instalment notice, the SIP card when value is below invested, and a calm link on the cancel screen. Never a gate on the cancel path	Discovery rate
Seen but not trusted	First-timers may not trust a chatbot with money questions, or think it will sell them a fund	Medium	High	Say up front what it is and isn't: no fund picks, not linked to sales; show data and sources in every answer	Discovery vs adoption gap
Wrong audience	Experienced investors try it, find it basic, and say so loudly	Medium	Low	Built and measured for first-year investors only; entry points shown to them first	Adoption among first-year investors

Risks to continued use

Risk	Why it could happen	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation	Watch
Answers feel generic or miss the question	The earlier version answered around questions instead of answering them	Medium	High	The agent fetches data with tools for every answer; rephrase and thumbs-down rates reviewed weekly; failing chats added to the 96 test cases	Rephrase rate, meaningful chat rate
Wrong number or fact	One wrong tax figure or return claim breaks trust	Medium	High	Tools do all the maths; the server blocks any number not in a tool result or the user's words; blocked replies are rewritten once, then replaced by a pre-written answer	Helpful answer rate

Risk	Why it could happen	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation	Watch
Users want fund picks and leave without them	3 of 4 testers asked for fund suggestions	High	Medium	Show the comparison by fund type over their time span and what to weigh; explain once why it doesn't name funds; each fund's page in Coin is one tap away	Return rate
Meaningful chat rate gamed or misread	Short confused back-and-forths could count as "meaningful"	Medium	Low	The definition needs a data-backed answer, not just 2 messages; reviewed against the rephrase rate	Rephrase rate

Risks to the success result (12-month retention)

Risk	Why it could happen	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation	Watch
Credit for a lift SIP Buddy didn't cause	Engaged investors use it and would have stayed anyway	High	High	Random holdout; compare everyone offered vs held out, not users vs non-users	Design check before launch
Too few people to see the lift	A 2-point lift needs about 6,300 per group; 100 per group shows only noise	Medium	High	Size the test from Coin's real baseline before launch; run until the number is reached	Sample size reached
The real cause is payment, not belief	Payment and mandate failures top the stop themes; three failures in a row discontinue a SIP; a chat can explain but not fix a bank mandate	High	High	Pair SIP Buddy with product fixes: a mandate health check, the SIP date matched to salary day, and a hand-off to support with the failure reason filled in	90-day retention, support load
A market crash during the test	A sharp fall raises stops in both groups and floods SIP Buddy with worried users	Medium	Medium	Both groups face the same months, so the comparison holds; load-test at 10 times normal traffic; switch to pre-written replies if speed or errors spike	Speed, fallback rate

Risk	Why it could happen	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation	Watch
90-day lift fades by month 12	Early gains may not last	Medium	Medium	Keep a 10% holdout for the full 12 months even after scaling	90-day vs 12-month gap

Risks that cut across all three

Risk	Why it could happen	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation	Watch
Seen as investment advice	Fund-type comparisons could be read as advice under SEBI's rules	Medium	Very high	No fund names, ranks or "suits you"; the rule check on every reply; 38 safety cases must all pass; compliance review before launch; logs kept for audit	Unsafe replies
Retention by friction	Pressure to hit the target could add steps to cancelling	Medium	High	Cancel friction is a guardrail that pauses rollout; SIP Buddy never asks "are you sure?"	Cancel friction
Steering into risky funds	Small caps' higher past returns could tip first-timers into them, then they quit in the next fall	Medium	High	Every comparison shows the worst 12 months and how often SIPs of that length ended below what went in	Risk drift
Stale data or rules	Index returns change monthly; tax rules change with each Budget	High	Medium	Monthly data refresh with an as-of date on every card; any fact change re-runs the 96-case gate	Days since last refresh
Personal data typed in	Users paste PAN or account numbers	Medium	Medium	Scrubbed on the page and on the server before the AI sees anything; the agent never asks for them	Personal data
Model change or cost rise	A model update changes behaviour; prices or limits change	Medium	Medium	Model version pinned; any change re-runs the gate; pre-written replies keep the page working	Cost, fallback rate

What would make this fail outright: low discovery and the payment cause together. If discovery stays low after the entry points ship, or 90-day retention doesn't move while payment failures stay high, the answer is a fix in the payment flow, not a better chat.

Sources

- AI Evidence Log: Coin SIP Discovery Engine: stop themes from 1,246 public posts, the MVP's quality gate runs and tester feedback
- INDmoney: SIP stoppage ratio explained: AMFI's rule that three failed instalments in a row discontinue a SIP (the payment risk in Part 8)
- Cafemutual: SIP stoppage ratio falls to 79% in September: industry context, 63.26 lakh new SIPs against 49.68 lakh closed in September 2026